

## Main

**Report Name (Org\_Country\_Year\_Report Type)**

Equal Education\_South Africa\_2022-23\_3-month report

**Fellowship Organization**

Equal Education (EE)

**Fellowship City**

Cape Town

**Fellowship Country**

South Africa

**Fellowship Start Date**

08/22/2022

**Anticipated Fellowship End Date**

09/11/2022

**What is your fellowship title/role?**

Fundraising and Communications Fellow

**What are your primary responsibilities?**

- Compile database of EE's prominent supporters and editors of the largest print and broadcast news platforms
- Improve the quality and quantity of traffic to the EE website through search engine optimisation
- Support the Communications Officer by creating social media content by capturing visuals of EE actions
- Update any content on the website as identified by yourself or by the Comms Officer
- Support with the publication of the Annual Report and The Equalizer Newsletter
- Support fundraising team by identifying potential donors, writing reports, and applying to grants

**I receive adequate direction and support to perform my fellowship responsibilities.**

Agree

**Did you receive any sort of orientation, handover or onboarding when you started your fellowship?**

Yes

**Please describe your orientation/onboarding and note who handled it.**

My onboarding was handled by HR and my managers in the Fundraising and Communications department. I met with staff from all of EE's different teams and learned about the organization's structure.

**If you did not receive any kind of orientation, what information or guidance were you provided at the start of your fellowship?**
**Describe a representative day at work.**

- I start work at 9AM. I either work from home or from the office. Every day is different but generally, I check-in with my colleagues and see to tasks that need to get done for the day.

**On average, how many hours per week do you work?**

40

**How would you describe your effectiveness in your fellowship post so far?**

Effective

**Please briefly describe 1-2 specific projects that you have undertaken or accomplishments you have made so far.**

- We applied for a grant with the United Nations and I took lead on the application
- We created a Tik Tok page and I helped create content for our page

**What is your organization's work culture like?**
**What is your office environment like? Please comment on the size and structure of the office(s) where you do most of your work.**

- The office environment is very relaxed and community oriented. The office has a lot of young people so it's always filled with energy and music.

**To whom do you report?**

Currently, I don't have a direct manager. The org is looking for managers to hire

**Have you had an initial check-in with your supervisor to set up a work plan and to set goals for your work during your fellowship year?**

Yes

**Was this meeting helpful in understanding your role and setting goals for your fellowship year?**

Yes, very helpful

**Please explain why you have not met with your supervisor and if you have plans to do so going forward.**
**Please briefly indicate 3-5 professional goals you have for the rest of your fellowship year. Your professional goals should align with your work plan.**

I want to create more content for our social media pages that captures the work EE does with collaboration with other staff.  
I want to update our website to ensure all our current work is communicated well to the public.  
I want to feel confident writing grants and leading fundraising campaigns

**Do you receive adequate direction/support to perform your fellowship responsibilities?**
**Please provide more information on your response above.**

Since this is early on my fellowship, I am still learning a lot about the work I am doing in communications and fundraising. By the end of the fellowship, I want to feel more confident in these departments and my skills.

Irregularly

**How often do you check in with your supervisor?**

**Have you had an opportunity to travel for work so far?**

No

**Describe this travel opportunity. Include location(s) and a brief description of the purpose of the trip(s).**

**I feel adequately prepared for my position's professional responsibilities.**

Agree

**Please briefly explain your response.**

I feel prepared for my professional responsibilities but I think it would be more beneficial to take courses in marketing and graphic design and Website management training.

## Life at Fellowship Site

### How did you travel to your host country and site? Please be specific

I flew Turkish Airlines from Boston to Istanbul and to Cape Town. I had a long layover in Istanbul, and the flight cost for one way ticket was around 850.

### What kind of visa/ permit do you have or applied for?

Tourist

### How did you obtain (or are obtaining) your visa or permit?

Upon Arrival

### Did you apply for and receive your visa / permit before heading to your host country or after arriving?

No

### What costs were associated with obtaining your visa or permit?

N/A

### Did you pay the visa / permit costs or were they covered by your organization?

N/A

### Are you still having challenges obtaining your visa/ permit?

Yes

### If yes, please explain further

I applied for a work exchange visa to South Africa and still have not received the work visa.

### g) Do you have any suggestions to help future Fellows navigate the visa / permit application process?

Apply early and stay on top of it!

### What vaccinations were you required to obtain prior to your departure? How much did your vaccinations cost? Did you get a yellow fever vaccination?

Yellow fever vaccine. My insurance covered it.

### How was your arrival and first week in your host country? Any improvements that could streamline the assimilation process for future Fellows?

I started work a few days after arrival which helped with assimilation and meeting people. There are also lots of opportunities to go out and explore the city for free a person can do alone safely.

### Is housing provided by and/or paid for by your organization? Please explain.

No, housing is covered by my stipend.

### Do you live in a location that is more urban or rural?

Very Urban

### Please describe your living environment

I live in Cape Town in the Southern Suburbs. It's a residential area and still very close to the main part of town

### How do you typically travel between your home and your work? How much does your daily transportation cost and how long is your commute?

I use Uber or get rides from other people. Daily transportation depends on where I am going. I normally drive to work with co-workers.

### If you live in a more rural area, what are the closest urban areas you can travel to for shopping, airport, larger medical centers, etc.?

I live in an urban area

### How is the weather in your host country? What season are you presently in?

We are in spring, moving towards summer in December.

### What is the appropriate clothing for work and outside of work at your fellowship post and in your community in general?

Work is very informal and relaxed. You can wear clothes for comfort

### How have you been spending your free time?

I have been exploring the city, meeting new friends, and going hiking or to the beach

### I've been able to successfully navigate my personal/social life both back at home and at my fellowship post.

Agree

### Please briefly explain your response below.

Moving to a new city as a young adult is bound to be hard no matter what. I struggled some days and made sure to reach out for help when I needed it.

### Would you say you live and work in a safe area?

Yes, my areas are safe. My work place is in a township and is harder to navigate but, I feel safe being at work

### What precautions do you take to ensure your safety?

I pay attention to my surroundings and try not to do things alone at night. I share my location with people and check-in consistently

### What has been your experience with crime so far? (Please note that any security or safety concerns or incidents should be reported directly to PiAf staff per PiAf safety and security protocol.)

I have no experiences with crime so far

### Describe the incidence of crime and the general security situation within your city/town. Could you recommend specific areas future Fellows might consider for safe housing? What about areas that should be avoided?

Cape Town has a high crime rate and especially is known for violence against women. Travelling alone at night is generally avoided

### Please refer back to the goals you set for yourself before orientation. Are you working towards these goals? Have you met any of them? Changed any of them? Please explain.

Yes, I am working toward these goals. I came in with general expectations but with an open mind. I have been surprised in the best ways by my time here and the people I am meeting. I am learning a lot more than I imagined.  
I don't think I have met any of my goals year, although I am working towards them in the best capacity.

**Do you have any frustrations with your living arrangements, your work or your life outside of work?**

I don't have any frustrations, I am more than glad for my experiences so far and my welcome into the city and work.

**Has there been anything that you have needed but have not been able to locate or acquire?**

No

**How have you dealt with "culture shock"?**

Not as much. Cape Town is a diverse city with people from all over the world

**What about your experience thus far has been the most...surprising?**

My most surprising experiences have been the mass meetings EE holds that brings together hundreds of students from all over the Western Cape to organize campaigns to better education. It is deeply grassroots and involves parents, teachers, and others who are invested in the work. It is also very fun!

**What about your experience thus far has been the most...challenging?**

The most challenging aspect of these experiences have been personal in nature for me. This is my first job and I am figuring out what type of adult I am and what I need to work on in terms of routine, being part of community and effective at work at the same time.

**What are the top 3 things you miss the most from your home country or the U.S.?**

N/A

**What are the top 3 things about life in your host country that beat out life in your home country or the U.S.?**

Nature (beach and mountains)  
kind people with open hearts  
Art scene (films, museums, music etc)

**How is your stipend being paid?**

Stipend is monthly and paid in U.S dollars in a U.S. account

**How are you receiving your stipend funds?**

Wire

**Did you raise funds to cover part of your fellowship expenses?**

No, I did not raise any funds

**Please list any additional one-time or infrequent expenses not included in your monthly budget below.**

Monthly Budget

|                        |                                    |                      |                  |                       |                                                                |
|------------------------|------------------------------------|----------------------|------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Rent</b>            | <b>Utilities</b>                   | <b>Furnishings</b>   | <b>Phone</b>     | <b>Home Security</b>  | <b>Internet</b>                                                |
| \$350.00               | \$0.00                             | \$0.00               | \$50.00          | \$0.00                | \$-0.04                                                        |
| <b>Transportation</b>  | <b>Fitness</b>                     | <b>Entertainment</b> | <b>Groceries</b> | <b>House Cleaning</b> | <b>Eating Out</b>                                              |
| \$150.00               | \$0.00                             | \$200.00             | \$250.00         | \$0.00                | \$100.00                                                       |
| <b>Medications</b>     | <b>Additional Health Insurance</b> | <b>Travel</b>        | <b>Laundry</b>   | <b>Other</b>          | <b>Total Monthly Budget (Minus Entertainment &amp; Travel)</b> |
| \$0.00                 | \$0.00                             | \$100.00             | \$0.00           | \$0.00                | 0.00                                                           |
| <b>Specify "Other"</b> |                                    |                      |                  |                       |                                                                |

## Final Thoughts

**PiAf's orientation was sufficient in preparing me to transition into my fellowship.**

Agree

**Please briefly explain your response about Orientation.**

The orientation brought a lot of resources to my attention and when I need them, I still have access to them

**Is there anything in particular that PiAf could cover at orientation that would have better prepared you for your fellowship post? Please specify.**

I do wish there was more time to build a strong community bond with everyone

**As we plan the upcoming PiAf Retreat, we hope to incorporate some Fellow suggestions into our programming. What are some topics or sessions you would like to see at the Retreat? (We appreciate your feedback however, we may not be able to accommodate all suggestions or requests this year.)**

I hope there's time to check-in on each other meaningfully and support one another with any challenges we're facing